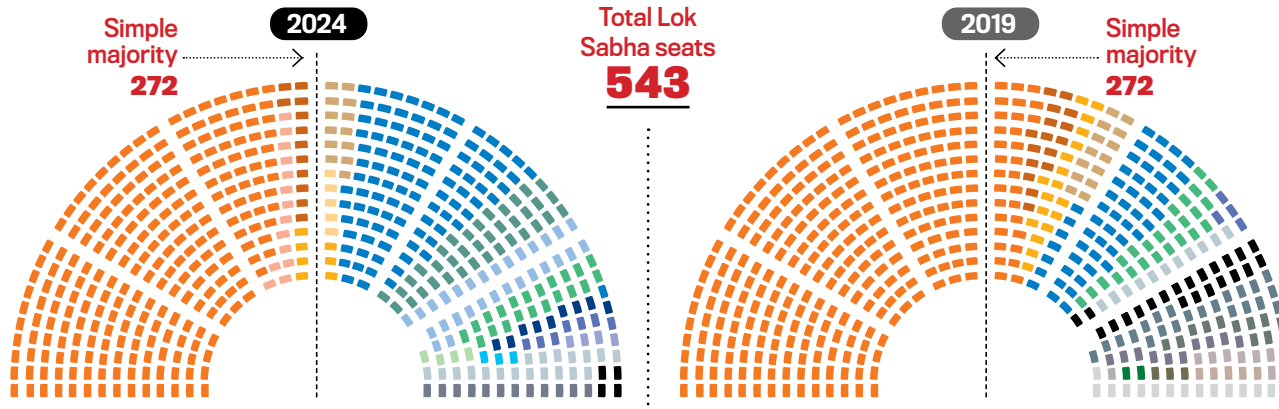
WHO GOT WHAT

With the BJP's tally dropping 20 per cent, from 303 seats in 2019 to 240 this time, it was left 32 seats short of a simple majority on its own



NDA 293
- BJP 240 (36.6%)
- TDP 16 (2%)
- JD(U) 12 (1.2%)
- SS 7 (1.1%)
- LJPRV 5 (0.4%)
- Others 13 (1.6%)

OTHERS 16
- YSRCP 4 (2.1%)
- Rest 12 (13.8%)

INDIA 234
- Cong. 99 (21.2%)
- SP 37 (4.6%)
- TMC 29 (4.4%)
- DMK 22 (1.8%)
- SS(UBT) 9 (1.5%)
- NCP(SP) 8 (0.9%)
- CPI(M) 4 (1.8%)
- RJD 4 (1.6%)
- AAP 3 (1.1%)
- Others 19 (2.3%)

NDA 352
- BJP 303 (37.4%)
- JD(U) 16 (1.5%)
- SS 18 (2.1%)
- Others 15 (3.9%)

UPA 91
- Cong. 52 (19.5%)
- DMK 24 (2.3%)
- NCP 4 (1.4%)
- Others 11 (3.5%)

OTHERS 100
- TMC 22 (4.1%)
- YSRCP 22 (2.5%)
- BJD 12 (1.7%)
- BSP 10 (3.7%)
- BRS 9 (1.3%)
- SP 5 (2.5%)
- TDP 3 (1.4%)
- AIMIM 2 (0.2%)
- AAP 1 (0.4%)
- Rest 14 (10.6%)

Source: ECI

brute majority ended up having a negative impact on the BJP's campaign. Especially after Rahul Gandhi and other INDIA partners accused the party of wanting such a majority to effect major constitutional changes to scrap, among other things, reservations for the backward classes, Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs). This clearly seemed to have spooked the voter, with the BJP tally in the 84 seats reserved for SCs dropping from 46 in 2019 to 30 this election. Their loss proved to be the Congress's gain, as the party, which won six SC seats in 2019, saw the number rise to 19 in 2024, and its alliance partner, the Samajwadi Party, gain another seven from the blank it drew in 2019. The INDIA TODAY-MyAxis exit poll results showed that there was an overall jump of 18 percentage points in Dalit votes for Congress and its allies across both general and SC reserved constituencies and a six percentage point drop for BJP & Co. The same held true for the ST voters, with the exit polls recording a 12 percentage point jump in vote share for INDIA and a two percentage point fall in the NDA's vote share. In terms of seats, out of the 47 reserved for STs, the BJP won 26, five less than in 2019, while the Congress cornered 12, eight more than its previous tally of four.

What this verdict also makes clear is that Brand Modi is diminishing and heavy reliance on this factor can only be to the BJP's detriment

THE RURAL THUMBS-DOWN

Another big takeaway from this election is that the INDIA formation successfully capitalised on voter discontent on two major fronts: unemployment and inflation. The recent CSDS

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY